

DON'T IGNORE SHORT MEN

Chidi Mbaebie

Port Harcourt

PLEASE allow me a space in your daily journal to air my view on the selection of persons for Biafran Army held on 10th instant.

This may not appeal to the interest of some of the readers, yet I feel apologetic to remark this. I am 22 years old with average education and about 5 feet 4 inches high. My weight is 9½ stone. I have for long been seeking how to engage myself for more active part in the present war of our survival.

The other day there was an announcement over the Radio Biafra, Port Harcourt station, inviting "all interested persons" — as it put it — to report at Bernard Carr field for recruitment into Biafra Army.

I put appearance

because I was zealous. I passed every test they put to us and would even pass the medical exam. I was surprised to hear that I was "under-height" and therefore disqualified.

It must be remembered that Napoleon Bonaparte was a great man. A gallant and enthusiastic soldier and yet he was a short man. That a man is short does not mean that he is disabled and invalid.

To-day we depend on brain power where height does not count. As a man, every man has equal part to play and a quota to contribute in our present war of survival irrespective of height.